FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-34-20004

Issue Title : INFORMATION ONLY - Translation of Weather Radar (WXR) Display Can Potentially Cause Navigation Display Artifacts

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3441-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
12/14/2020	12/14/2020	12/11/2020
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Description

737 MAX aircraft use a Collins Aerospace MAX Display System (MDS) which may display graphical artifacts when the airplane heading/track differ. This condition can continue until either the WXR / Display mode is changed, or enough time has passed to allow the artifact to be translated off the display.

This condition can exist for operators with either Collins or Honeywell Weather Radar Systems installed and is not a fault condition.

Status

The Weather Radar System sends data to the Navigation Displays (ND) based on aircraft heading which is +/-90 degrees from the nose of the airplane, regardless of airplane track. The displays then rotate that data to account for differences in heading and track to ensure the data is properly located on the ND (i.e., all WXR data is translated by the displays to compensate for the forward motion of the airplane).

Whenever aircraft heading and track differ, the Collins display system on the MAX will continue to translate data behind the area that is actively being scanned and painted by the WXR System. This can result in a slight ‘wedge’ or ‘spoke’ shaped artifact which has the same dimensions as the angular difference of the heading / track.

This phenomenon can become more pronounced when there is a larger difference between aircraft heading / track, and a ‘soft’ mode change occurs. A ‘soft’ mode change is considered one of the following, depending on the supplier of the system installed:

–Collins WXR-2100A: Change to the AUTO/MAN, Tilt, Gain, or Ground Clutter on the WXR Control Panel.

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–Honeywell RDR-4000: Change to AUTO/MAN, Alt, or Gain on the WXR Control Panel.

This condition is a result of how the MDS translates the WXR data onto the ND, and can occur whenever the heading / track divergence is greater than 0 degrees and a soft mode change is initiated by the flight crew. During a 'soft' mode change, the translated data is not removed and will remain visible until translated off the display. Depending on the display range setting, angular difference between heading / track, and ground speed, timing may vary as to how long it takes for the 'wedge' or 'spoke' to be cleared from the display.

Please see the FTD Attachment – 'Graphic Representation of WXR Display Translation' for diagram references.

Interim Action

If a 'wedge' or 'spoke' is displayed, it can be removed in 12-16 seconds by performing a 'hard' mode change where the translated data is completely removed and redrawn with new data from the WXR System.

A 'hard' mode change is one where the flight crew changes one of the following:

- Display Control Panel (DCP) Range
- Navigation Display (ND) Mode
- WXR mode: WX, WX+T, TFR, MAP, or TEST
- WXR System Select (Dual System Only)

Final Action

No Action Required. Note that this is not considered a fault condition as the WXR System is operating per design.

Milestones

Not Applicable.

Related Categories

- Best Practices / Operational Efficiency : Operational / Maintenance-focused best practices, techniques, health checks or recommendations for preserving aircraft efficiency.
- Flight Deck Effects and Maintenance Messages : Issue that occurs frequently and causes a flight deck effect or maintenance message

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- Flight Operations : Flight Operations

Attachments:

a) Graphic Representation of WXR Display Translation

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